

Answers to Question 1:

- a) My name is Ashish Pant. People call me by my first name - Ashish.
- b) My major is Applied Statistics. I started the MAS program in the Spring 26
- c) Other than a statistics course in college, which was 30+ years ago, I recently took a course - The Power of Statistics by Google - on Coursera.org.
- d) As a Quantitative Trader since 2014, I have tried to use statistics to study market data. I am familiar with descriptive statistics, plotting, types of plots, binning etc. Most of my statistics experience is related to EDA but most of the time, I had no clue what I was doing which is primarily why I am in this program.
- e) I have 30+ years of programming experience in various languages including Python, but prior to this course, I have never worked with R or RStudio.

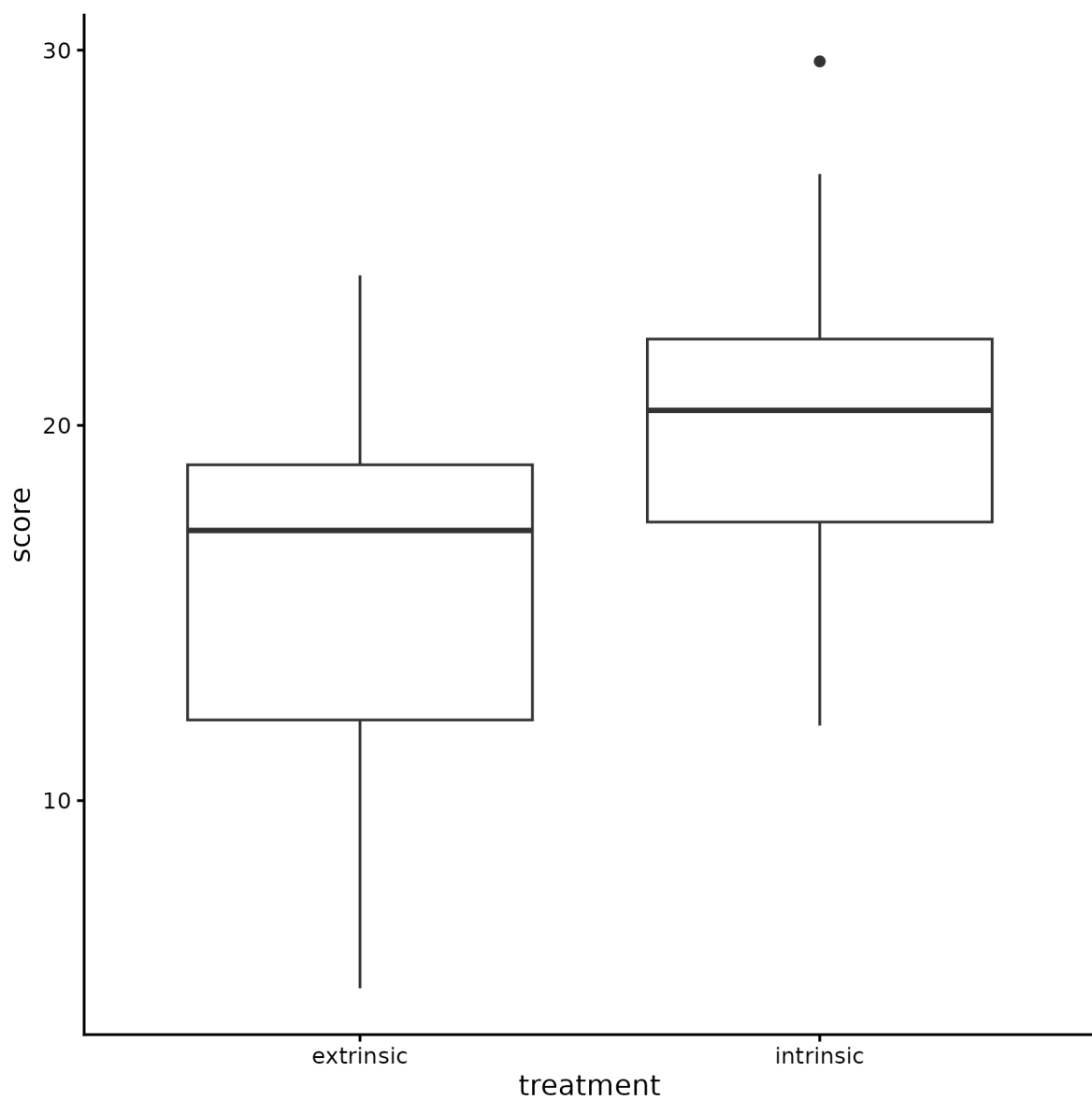
Answers to Question 2:

- a) In March 2023, I developed models to trade commodities futures markets based exclusively on binning. For each variable in my historical dataset, I used Python packages like optbinning to best describe the relationship between that variable and market price. Then, I created ensembles of several variables that seemed to have a monotonic relationship with price when tested against hold-out (unseen) data. I generated backtests based on hypothetical results to confirm commercial feasibility. And then, I made the worst decision of my career - I decided to use these models to actually trade the markets. As you can probably guess, these models failed to perform when subjected to live data.
- b) Mystery.
- c) A Parking Valet or Uber driver.

Answers to Question 3

- a) I have not interacted with my course mates yet. I do not prefer to be assigned to a group but I do not mind being part of one.
- b) I have extensive experience working with large amounts of data. But I have never used R. My experience is in Python, Java, C# and C++.

Answer to Question 4:



Box-plot showing scores for each treatment